

CAROLINE.CAHILL

@SETU.IE

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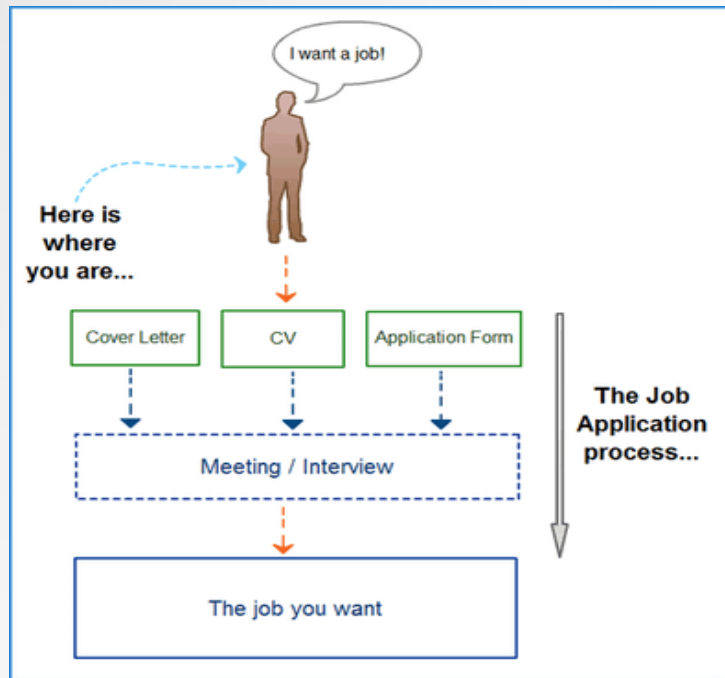




CAROLINE CAHILL

CV

PURPOSE OF A CV



- To introduce and present yourself in order to obtain an interview.
- To confirm your skills, abilities and experience for a prospective employer.
- To project your personality.
- To prepare yourself to speak about your background and experience at **interviews**.

EMPLOYERS CRITERIA

KSAOS

Knowledge, **S**kills, **A**ilities and **O**ther Attributes

- What do you know?
- What specific job related skills have you?
- What are you able to do?
- What else?

FIRST BASIC QUESTION

“Tell me about yourself”

= “talk to me about your CV”

= “Tell me about your course”

= “what’s your experience”

= “what’s your main area of interest” etc.

*****YOU CAN PREPARE ONE ANSWER*****

YOU SHOULD INCLUDE THESE CV HEADINGS

- Personal Statement (optional)
- Personal details
- Education and Qualifications/Hard Skills
- Employment History
- Interests/Volunteerism etc.
- Referees (at least one from SETU)

PERSONAL DETAILS

- **Personal Statement (optional)**

- The recruiter can see at a glance who you are and what exactly you are looking for. They should be used carefully.

- **Personal details**

- Name
- Contact telephone number
- Email address – must be professional, make it easy to read i.e. you don't want them to mix up letter l with the number one etc.

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS/HARD SKILLS

Up first:

- Bachelor of Science (Ord) in Forestry
- Bachelor of Science (Ord) in Horticulture

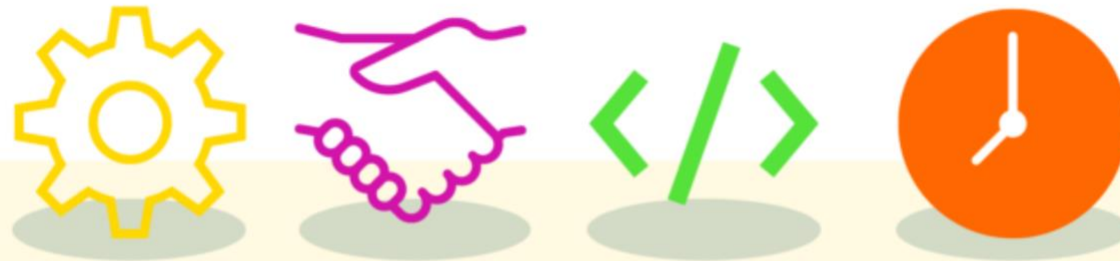
Then add in:

- Your other educational course(s) and years

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

- Detail overall (average) grades and the breakdown of your subjects within your degree (especially those **relevant** to your application).
 - An employer DOES NOT want a list of modules
- They want to know what YOU have learned

Hard Skills **VS** Soft Skills



What are the differences? Which is more important?

The main differences between hard skills and soft skills are 1) how you obtain them and 2) how you apply them in the workplace. Hard skills are usually obtained through hands-on experience or education. On the other hand, soft skills are more akin to personality traits that you have naturally developed throughout your life. Hard skills include specific, technical knowledge needed for a job. Soft skills tend to be interpersonal. **Both are important for career success.**

Definition



Hard Skills

Hard skills, or technical skills, are learned through education or hands-on experience. These are concrete, measurable abilities that are often specific to a job.

Soft Skills

Soft skills, or people skills, are traits and abilities that you develop throughout your entire life. Soft skills speak to how and why you are motivated to do certain things.

Examples



- Foreign languages
- Adobe Creative Suite
- Healthcare-related certifications or licenses
- Programming languages (JavaScript, etc)
- Website development
- Content development
- Copywriting
- Copyediting
- Budgeting
- SEO marketing
- Statistical analysis
- User interface (UI) design
- Proofreading
- Communication
- Critical thinking
- Adaptability
- Creativity
- Problem-solving
- Organization
- Willingness to learn
- Leadership
- Dependability
- Work ethic
- Teamwork
- Time management
- Decision-making

TRANSFERRABLE SKILLS [VIDEO]

- WRITE DOWN 5-10 KEYWORDS YOU TAKE FROM THIS:



SKILLS AND QUALITIES THAT EMPLOYERS SEEK

- *Drive/Energy* - the desire to get things done.
- *Motivation* - enthusiasm, a willingness to ask questions, keen to do that little bit extra on each job.
- *Communication skills* - the ability to explain things clearly, through speech and in writing, in our own and, increasingly, another's language.
- *Confidence* - able to relate to people at all levels, friendly, open and honest in their communications.
- *Reliability* - follows up and doesn't rely on others to ensure that a job is done
- *Analytical ability* - doesn't jump to the first solution that presents itself.
- *Honesty/Integrity* - a willingness to take responsibility for your actions.
- *Pride in a job well done* - someone who is attentive to detail.
- *Dedication* - does whatever it takes in time and effort to ensure a successful result.
- *Listening skills* - to understand and take account of alternative points of view.
- *Determination* - someone who will not back off when a problem or situation gets tough.

YOU ALL POSSESS THESE SKILLS!!!

DO NOT LIST
MEANINGLESS
MODULE
TITLES

- **For example, you might detail in your CV:**

Hard Skills:

- a) Fundamentals in **Health & Safety** from completion of XXX course
- b) Confidence in **MS Word** to generate professional looking documents.

Soft Skills:

- a) **Communications** skills vastly improved from field trips including...

TAKE 5 MINUTES:



-
- On a page:
 1. **list** specific skills you have gained since beginning your course (about 10)
 - 2.
 3. and
 4. **list** skills *you* possess that are *transferrable* across any job (about 10, for example communication skills, time management)

CV HEADINGS



Skills Profile

This is an opportunity to show how your overall experience matches the requirements of the job.

- Use it to draw together different **experiences** under one core skill.
 - For example, teamwork could include a group project from last Semester, youth club, travel experience etc., particularly if you have not referred to these earlier in terms of skills gained.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

- Emphasise both **what you have learned** and how **you** have made a difference to your employer.
- Emphasise the **skills gained** in each job:
 - previous full-time work experience, at whatever level, can be used to provide evidence of the skills and qualities required.

CV HEADINGS

- **Interests and activities**

- Mention any positions of responsibility that you have held in societies/clubs in College or in any outside organisations.
- Emphasise any skills that you have gained, e.g. teamwork, leadership, organisational.

- **Achievements**

- An achievement is any activity you have completed successfully

- **Additional information**

- Any other awards or qualifications not mentioned earlier

- **Referees**

Get permission before you use someone as a referee and include **one academic** referee.

- Include name, job title & email/phone.

KEY ELEMENTS OF A GOOD CV

- Clear, concise, and positive, business-like language.
- Attractive layout. Easy to read, leave sufficient 'white space', preferably using size 12 font.
- Ideally ONE, max two pages for Ireland and UK.
- Be mindful of the data that you give and to whom!

No spelling errors or typos. This is key and is the reason why many CVs get culled.



KEY ELEMENTS OF A GOOD CV

- **Action words** eg. 'Responsible for ...' rather than 'Minding...' and 'I developed...' rather than 'We did ...'.
- **Bullet** points work better than large paragraphs of text.
- Use **enthusiastic** language in your CV to convey your interest to the employer.
- Try to **avoid using abbreviations**, or overly technical language when writing your CV.



CV PRESENTATION

- 'business-like' email address
- Use standard fonts
- Keep the text simple and the presentation plain

Name file suitably i.e.

CarolineCahill_PlacementCV.pdf

- Email as **.pdf**

If an employer scans it: **is it obvious:**

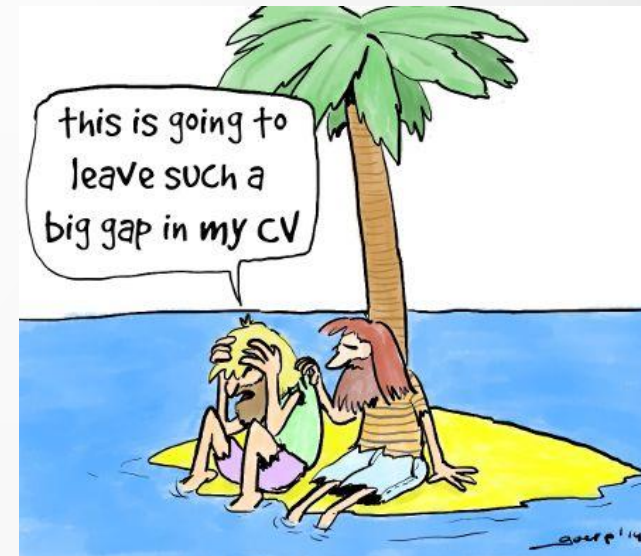
Do they “get” **your** specific skills &
your specific qualifications.

GAPS ON CV

NEVER LIE



PEOPLE HAVE GAPS ON CV, JUST EXPLAIN!



WHAT NOT TO DO:

- Do not include any thing that might be considered as a failure.
- Do not use flamboyant formatting.
- No photos unless requested.
- Do not enhance results
- Do not lie

- **Additional:**
- Be able to provide referee details easily and without hesitation.
- Be able to provide confirmation of academic results or at least how one can verify results

